

Andreas Kuepfer

Computational Political Scientist

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Current Position

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| 01/2026-present | Postdoctoral Researcher
Technical University of Darmstadt
Institute for Political Science (Christian Stecker) |
| 05/2022-12/2025 | Research Associate
Technical University of Darmstadt
Institute for Political Science (Christian Stecker) |
| 10/2024-02/2025 | Research Associate
MZES, University of Mannheim
Data and Methods Unit |

Education

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| 2022-2026 | Ph.D. Political Science , University of Mannheim
Supervisors: Christian Stecker and Christian Arnold
Committee: Thomas Gschwend, Marc Ratkovic, Christian Stecker
Thesis: <i>Multimodal Data and Open Science: Innovations in the Study of Political Communication and Behaviour</i> |
| 2019-2022 | M.Sc. Data Science , University of Mannheim
Supervisors: Thomas Gschwend and Denis Cohen
Thesis: <i>When local context trumps party unity: Using Twitter and NLP to explain geographical heterogeneity in legislators' policy communication</i> |
| 2015-2019 | B.Sc. Business Information Systems , University of Applied Sciences Karlsruhe |
| 2017 | ERASMUS Student (Studies Abroad), B.Sc. Informatics , Metropolia University of Applied Sciences in Helsinki, Finland |

Publications

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| 2025 | <u>The sound of party competition: how applause reflects unity, disagreement, and the electoral cycle in parliaments</u>
A. Küpfer, J. Müller, C. Stecker
West European Politics |
| 2025 | <u>The Politics of Seeking and Avoiding Discourse in Parliament</u>
E. Koch, A. Küpfer
European Journal of Political Research |
| 2024 | <u>Nonrandom Tweet Mortality and Data Access Restrictions: Compromising the Replication of Sensitive Twitter Studies</u>
A. Küpfer
Political Analysis |
| 2024 | <u>The Role of Hyperparameters in Machine Learning Models and How to Tune Them</u>
C. Arnold, L. Biedebach, A. Küpfer, M. Neunhoeffner
Political Science Research and Methods |

Working Papers

Structuring Quantitative Image Analysis with Object Prominence

C. Arnold, A. Küpfer

R&R

A Pipeline for Extracting Data from Videos of Complex Subnational Politics

M. Holman, A. Küpfer, T. Simko

R&R

Gaze and Power: Opposition Status, Gender, and the Far Right

A. Küpfer

Under Review

Alignment Helps Make the Most of Multimodal Data

C. Arnold, A. Küpfer

Under Review

Far-Right Speeches and Emotional Contagion in Parliament: Sequential and Multimodal Evidence from Germany

C. Arnold, A. Küpfer, C. Stecker

Introducing Workflow Management to Computational Social Science

A. Küpfer, C. Arnold

Measuring Media Slant through Image Analysis

C. Arnold, A. Küpfer, O. Rittmann, M. Torres

When Words Divide: MPs as Polarisation Entrepreneurs on the Digital Civic Platform abgeordnetenwatch.de

C. Sheldon, A. Küpfer, C. Arnold

Research Visits and Summer Schools

01/2026-10/2026	Centre for Artificial Intelligence in Government (CAIG) (Christian Arnold) , University of Birmingham, UK
10/2024-10/2025	Data and Methods Unit , Mannheim Centre for European Research (MZES), University of Mannheim, Germany
06/2024	Video Research Institute, Center for C-SPAN Scholarship & Engagement (CCSE) (Bryce Dietrich) , Purdue University, US
02/2024-03/2024	Centre for Artificial Intelligence in Government (CAIG) (Slava Jankin) , University of Birmingham, UK

Grants, Certificates, and Awards

2025	Grant: APSA Political Communication Travel Award, 600\$
2025	Certificate: TU Darmstadt Higher Education Teaching Certificates: Professional Competence Level (200 work units)
2024	Grant: German Research Foundation (DFG) Grant “Analysing Legislative Politics with Aligned Text, Audio, and Image Data” with Christian Arnold and Christian Stecker, 285’000€
2024	Grant: APSA Political Communication SPARK Travel Award, 750\$
2023	Award: Athene Award for Excellent Teaching “Promoting data literacy, strengthening critical thinking, taking individual needs into account, integrating modern tools” (TU Darmstadt), 2’000€

Teaching and Supervision

Master Thesis Supervisions: 1

Student Assistant Supervisions: 5

2026	From Desktop to Cluster: Scaling Computational Social Science with High-Performance Computing , 3-hour workshop, COMPTExT Conference
2024	Machine Learning for Social Scientists , PhD graduate school course, MZES (with Ruben Bach)
2024	Introduction to Analysis and Comparison of Political Systems , Undergraduate proseminar, Technical University of Darmstadt
2023	Quantitative Text Analysis in R , Postgraduate seminar, Technical University of Darmstadt
2023	Data Analysis: From Data Crawling to Visualization , Guest lecture (180 minutes), National University of Kyiv-Mohyla Academy
2023	Getting started with Python: A how-to guide for social scientists , Workshop with two sessions à 90 minutes, MZES Social Science Data Lab (with Ruben Bach)
2022, 2023	Introduction to Quantitative Methods in R , Postgraduate seminar, Technical University of Darmstadt
2022	Collection, Management, and Analysis of Twitter Data: Using the Twitter API for Academic Research and BERT , Workshop (90 minutes), MZES Social Science Data Lab
2017	IT Security and Operating Systems , Undergraduate tutorial, University of Applied Sciences Karlsruhe
2016	Programming II , Undergraduate tutorial, University of Applied Sciences Karlsruhe
2016	Introduction to Business Informatics , Undergraduate tutorial, University of Applied Sciences Karlsruhe

Research Dissemination

Invited Talks

2026	Social Science Data Lab , University of Mannheim, Germany
2025	Data Science Brown Bag Series , Hertie School, Berlin, Germany
2025	Social Data Science Seminar , University of Mannheim, Germany
2024	Mittelbau Colloquium , MZES, University of Mannheim, Germany
2024	Text-as-Data (TADA) Speaker Series , Virtual

Conferences

2026	EPSS , Belfast, UK
2026	ParliView Workshop , Dublin, Ireland
2023, 2024, 2025, 2026	COMPTExT^{P,d,c} , (UK, Netherlands, Austria)
2026	DVPW SekMethoden^d , Hannover, Germany
2024, 2025	APSAP^P , (USA, Canada)
2025	PSA , Birmingham, UK
2022, 2023, 2024, 2026	EPSA^{P,d,c} , (Czech Republic, UK, Germany)
2023, 2024	IASGP Annual Conference^{P,c} , (Germany)

- 2023 ECPR Standing Group on Parliaments^{p,d,c}, Vienna, Austria
- 2022 DVPW Group Comparative Research on Parliaments^p, Bremen, Germany
- 2022 PolMeth Europe^p, Hamburg, Germany
- 2021 PolMeth Europe, Virtual

p = Presenter, d = Discussant, c = Panel Chair/Roundtable

Press

- 2025 [Applaus-O-Meter: Zwei Fraktionen applaudieren vor allem sich selbst](#), Frankfurter Allgemeine Sonntagszeitung (FAS) (with Jochen Müller and Christian Stecker)
- 2025 [When do politicians engage in discourse – and when do they avoid it?](#), LSE EUROPP – European Politics and Policy Blog (with Elias Koch)
- 2023 [Der Frankfurter Wahlkompass VOTO zur OB-Wahl 2023](#), [FAZ](#) (with Thilo Dieing and Christian Stecker)
- 2023 [Wahlrecht ab 16, mehr autofreie Zonen und gebührenfreie Kinderbetreuung? Die Positionen der Kandidierenden zur Oberbürgermeisterwahl in Darmstadt in der Online-Wahlhilfe VOTO](#), [Darmstädter Echo](#) (with Christian Stecker)
- 2023 [Wahlkompass bietet Orientierung im Kandidatenschwungel \(FAZ\)](#), (with Christian Stecker)
- 2023 [Viele Köpfe und ein breites Angebot. Die Positionen der Kandidierenden zur Frankfurter Oberbürgermeisterwahl](#), [FAZ](#) (with Christian Stecker)

Web Publications

- 2023 [BERT and Explainable AI](#), Methods Bites, Blog of the Mannheim Centre for European Research (MZES) Social Science Data Lab
- 2022 [Collection, Management, and Analysis of Twitter Data](#), Methods Bites, Blog of the Mannheim Centre for European Research (MZES) Social Science Data Lab

Software

- 2022 **triviz**, Triangular visualizations for the significance of pairwise differences from multigroup comparisons (Denis Cohen and *Andreas Küpfer*)

Referee

Computational Communication Research • Computational Linguistics for the Political and Social Sciences at KONVENS (Workshop), 2024 & 2025 • Information, Communication and Society • Nature Scientific Data • Political Analysis • Politische Vierteljahresschrift • Zeitschrift für Politikwissenschaft

Service

Local Co-Organizer of the 2026 [COMPTExT Conference](#) (04/2026) • Co-Organizer/Contributor of the [Social Science Data Lab \(SSDL\)](#) at MZES (03/2021-10/2025) • Co-Organizer of the 2024 [ECPR Summer School on Parliaments](#) (08/2024) • Member of the decision committee for the German public-private scholarship (Deutschlandstipendium) (11/2023-10/2025) • Data infrastructure representative (since 11/2023)

Selected Work Experience (Academia)

03/2021-09/2024	Student Research Assistant at Social Science Data Lab , Mannheim Centre for European Research (MZES) (Denis Cohen)
10/2020-12/2021	Student Research Assistant at Chair of Political Science, Quantitative Methods in the Social Sciences , University of Mannheim (Thomas Gschwend)
09/2021-12/2021	Student Research Assistant at Project Data Science and Big Data at Schools Prodabi , Paderborn University (Rolf Biehler)

Selected Work Experience (Industry)

10/2021-present	Data Scientist , Freelancer, Remote
07/2018-02/2020	Working Student Data Science/Finance , SAP SE in Walldorf, Germany
02/2018-07/2018	Internship Custom Solution Development , Capgemini in Stuttgart, Germany
09/2012-07/2015	Traineeship Software Developer , KUMAVISION AG in Tiengen, Germany